The difference in mass between subspecies of common chaffinch, *Fringilla coelebs*

Emma Rand

Introduction

A number of subspecies of the common chaffinch, *Fringilla coelebs*, have been described based principally on the differences in the pattern and colour of the adult male plumage[1]. Two of groups of these subspecies are the "coelebs group" (Figure 1a) that occurs in Europe and Asia and the "canariensis group" (Figure 1b) that occurs on the Canary Islands.



(a) *F. c. coelebs* (b) *F. c. palmae*

Figure 1: **Adult male *Fringilla coelebs*.** Coelebs group on the left (Andreas Trepte, CC BY-SA 2.5 https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/2.5, via Wikimedia Commons) and canariensis group on the right (H. Zell, CC BY-SA 3.0 https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0, via Wikimedia Commons).

This study sought to determine whether the two subspecies differ in mass. The raw data are in File S1.

Methods

We randomly sampled 20 *F. c. coelebs* males and 20 *F. c. palmae* males and determined their mass with spring scales. Analysis was carried out with R version 4.3.1[2] and tidyverse[3] packages.

In the results section Table 2 is generated from a code chunk by passing a data frame to the `kable` function from the `knitr` package. But Table 1 is a "markdown table" that is written directly in the document.

Table 1: Primer sequences used in the RT-PCR experiments. This has nothing to do with chaffinches at all. It was just a table I could copy in from elsewhere.

Gene	Forward Primer	Reverse Primer	Product size (bp)
Tbx6.L	CCAGATGGGCCACATCATCCT	ATTAGAGGCTCCAGGCCCC	975
GAPDH.L	CACAGACTTACACAGGGGTTG	TCGCCCCACTTAATGTTGCT	307
Cdx4.L	AATCGACTTCTACAGGCAAGAC	ACAGAACACAGCCACAAACTG	244
ODC.L	GCAAAGTGGATCTGATGATGAAGAA	CTGGCAAAACACAAGCTACAAAT	735

Results

Canariensis ($\bar{x} \pm s.e.$: 22.27 $\pm$ 0.48 g) have significantly higher mass than coelebs (20.48 $\pm$ 0.48 g)(t = 2.65; $d.f.$ = 38; p = 0.01). See Figure 2

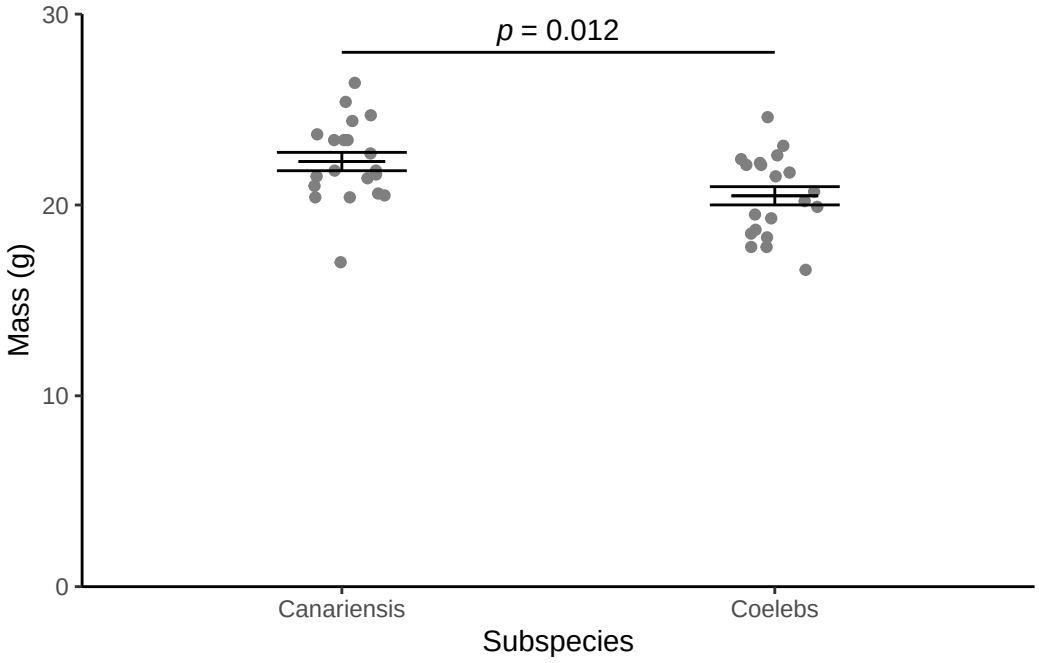


Figure 2: **Canariensis chaffinches are heavier than Coelebs chaffinches**. The mean mass of 20 randomly sampled males from each subspecies was determined. Error bars are $\pm$ 1 standard error. Canariensis chaffinches were significantly heavier than Coelebs (t = 2.65; $d.f.$ = 38; p = 0.01). Data analysis was conducted in R[2] with tidyverse packages[3].

There is another figure showing the distribution of the data in Figure 3 presented here only to demonstrate the auto numbering of figures. The same figure is in "Supplemental Figures". See Figure S1

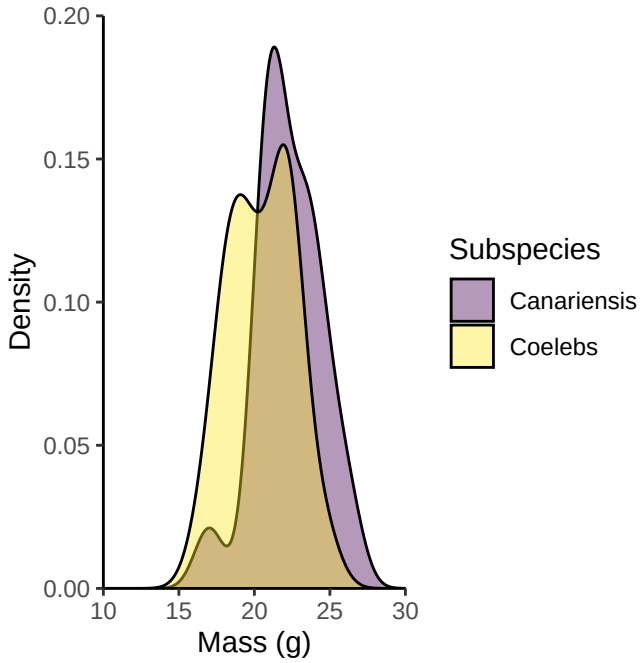


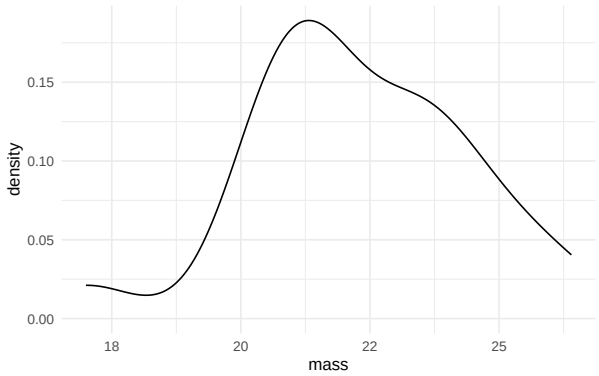
Figure 3: Unnecessary extra figure to demonstrate the autonumbering.

These results are gratuitously reproduced in Table 2 just to include a table.

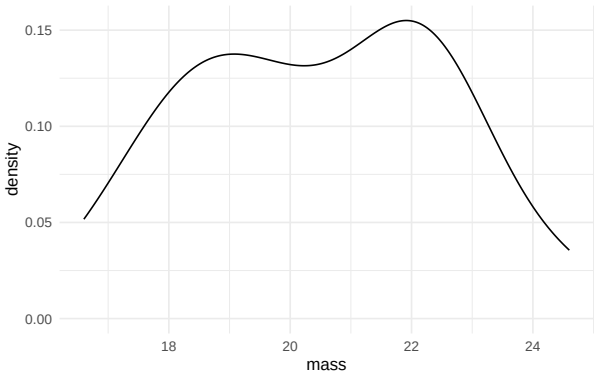
Table 2: Summary of mass(g) for the two subspecies of chaffinch.

Subspecies	Mean	Sd	N	Se
Canariensis	22	2.1	20	0.48
Coelebs	20	2.1	20	0.48

I have created a mutli-column figure with mixed content. Take a look at Figure 4. You can see two histograms in Figure 4a and Figure 4b. There is also a photo of a chaffinch in Figure 4c.



(a)



(b)



(c) *F. c. coelebs*

Subspecies	Mean	Sd	N	Se
Canariensis	22	2.1	20	0.48
Coelebs	20	2.1	20	0.48

(d) Summary of mass(g) for the two subspecies of chaffinch.

Figure 4: A figure with a some plots and a photo. There's even a table in there although, IMO tables should not be in figures, but placed separately. I had to use the fig- prefix in the label to get make it be treated like a figure with caption below etc.

Discussion

Here we pick up points from the introduction.

Word count: 62 words.

References

1. Suárez, N.M., Betancor, E., Klassert, T.E., Almeida, T., Hernández, M., and Pestano, J.J. (2009). Phylogeography and genetic structure of the Canarian common chaffinch (Fringilla coelebs) inferred with mtDNA and microsatellite loci. Molecular Phylogenetics and Evolution *53*, 556–564. 10.1016/j.ympev.2009.07.018.

2. R Core Team (2023). R: A language and environment for statistical computing (R Foundation for Statistical Computing).

3. Wickham, H., Averick, M., Bryan, J., Chang, W., McGowan, L.D., François, R., Grolemund, G., Hayes, A., Henry, L., Hester, J., et al. (2019). Welcome to the {tidyverse}. *4*, 1686. 10.21105/joss.01686.

Supplemental

Files

File S1

chaff.txt

File S2

example-pdf.pdf

Figures

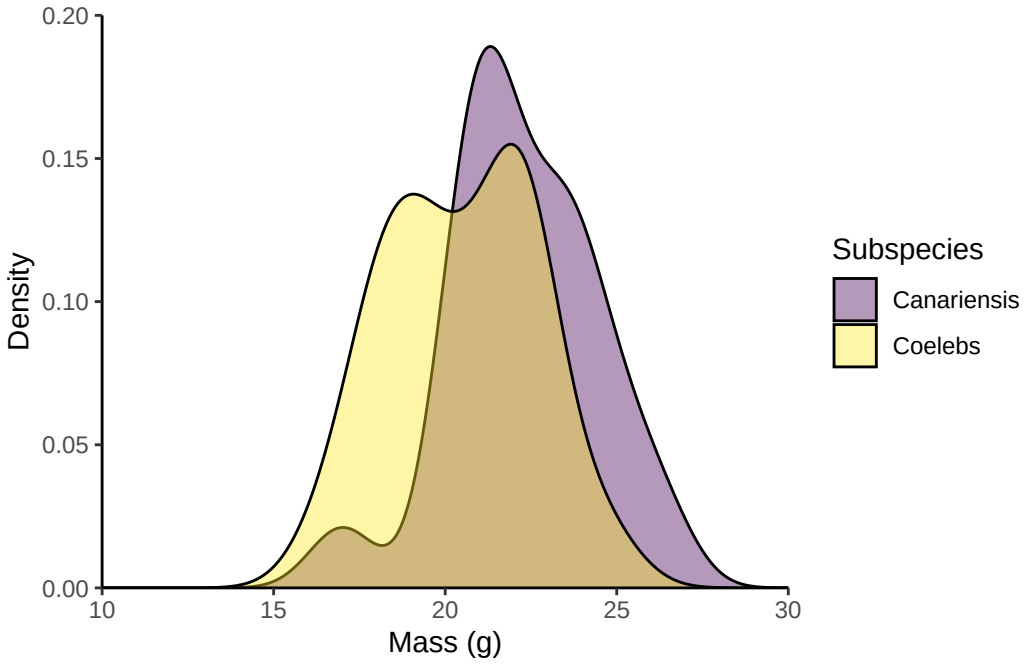


Figure S1: **Here's that same figure again**. but this time it's in the supplemental material.